

A Letter For You

--- with love ---

Happy Birthday to my Cutulu, and my absolute favorite person in the world.

On this special occasion, I want to take a trip down memory lane and recall everything that brought us here. We've had so many great moments, and a few tough ones too, but the one thing that remains perfectly stable is our bond. I constantly catch myself thinking: what if I hadn't joined that 20s Discord server? What if, on 16-10-2025, I hadn't texted this 19-year-old girl who loves to twerk to songs just like I do? I would have missed out on a wonderful girl—sorry, a wonderful woman, now that you've turned 20! The thought of missing you actually haunts me, but destiny clearly had other plans.

When we first started talking, I absolutely loved our conversations. Even when you judged me and called me a "Creep," I didn't get mad because I know how people in society can be. Honestly, I felt good knowing that you aren't easily fooled and that you are strong. Even though I worried about bothering you by texting, something inside me just said, "What could go wrong? I'm not making her uncomfortable. I should text her." They say people lack the courage to do things sober that they easily do when they're high. If I could remember where I bought the booze that gave me the courage to text you that day, I'd gift that guy 1 Crore Rupees (Rs)! But jokes aside, Yuhku, I am so incredibly glad I texted you again on 16-12-2025. That was the day our entire dynamic changed forever.

January was a bit of a rollercoaster. Early on, things didn't go so well with our silly fights and silent treatments. But by the end of the month, we had cleared our differences. Then came 24-01-2026 the day you confessed your feelings. I was so happy, but also confused and a little sad because I questioned if I was actually capable of being a good boyfriend. But when I reflected on everything between us, I realized the love, mutual respect, and support were always there. From the very beginning, you showed genuine interest in my life, cared for me, and constantly checked on me. You are intelligent, smart, and know exactly where you want to stand in life. I have always admired your artwork and your journaling; I always wanted to do those things but couldn't, and watching you do them just made me even more attracted to you. I realized that this pure connection was enough to drive my love for you, and I didn't need to "try hard" just to be a good boyfriend. So, on 26-01-2026, I told you exactly what I felt. I was so tense, afraid it might make you freak out, but luckily, you accepted my feelings.

That beautiful moment led us right into February, our honeymoon and post-honeymoon phase. Those first two weeks were pure magic, all lovey-dovey, where everything we said gave us butterflies. When we decided to have our first VC on 16-02-2026, I was beyond excited to finally talk to you face-to-face. I know that first call didn't go exactly as expected, but it was one of the best things to ever happen to us. It was a true verification of our relationship. We didn't force anything, we didn't pressure each other; we just existed together and started doing fun activities like our watchalongs.

March flew by so fast. Even though we had that brief three-day silent patch at the end of February, we solved the issue and picked right back up where we left off. The month started with the heavy, sad demise of your Dadi. I felt so bad for you, knowing the massive impact grandparents have on our lives, but I am so incredibly proud of how you overcame that grief. By the end of March, when you shared your exam schedule and actually asked me if I wanted to meet, I was overjoyed. It proved this wasn't a forced bond. I will never forget booking those tickets on 23-03-2026 and sharing the amazing news with you.

April brought its challenges, mostly for you with your Sem End Exams. I watched you work so hard, navigating the stress and mood swings. I was so worried about your health when you weren't getting enough sleep, especially with the additional distractions at Altha's house. But you pushed through it all and gave your absolute best during your preparation.

And then came May. Ah, the best month of my life. Our meeting date was finally close, but we hit a roadblock when my waitlisted tickets got canceled. I was so disturbed and explored every single option, but thankfully we found a solution. I will never forget that travel day: heading to the Hyderabad airport, staying up all night, and finally reaching Ahmedabad the next morning. It all still feels like a dream. The day we officially met, when you texted that you had reached near my hotel, my heart rate skyrocketed. I was so happy and so tense. I walked out, and there stood a 5'3" girl with a scarf wrapped all around her head, but I knew it was you instantly because of those big, damn cute eyes. I might have been smiling on the outside, but inside, my heart was crying pure tears of joy. When I asked to hold your hand for the first time and you gave it to me, I couldn't believe it was real (which is exactly why I asked you to pinch me!).

Our first date had such a perfectly balanced vibe. I knew it was a lot for your 19-year-old brain and heart to process—sneaking around avoiding people from your college, all while running on a tired brain that lacked rest from exam week. I expected the exhaustion, but I did feel sad when the bangles I got didn't fit your hand. Yet, the way you comforted me made all that sadness instantly vanish.

Day two at Mould Gandhinagar was amazing. We took pictures, played games, talked endlessly, and had that beautiful time at the garden discussing our childhoods. Even though we got a bit hurt and were late getting you back to your hostel, by the end of the day, everything was perfectly set.

Day three was our movie date! We missed half the movie, but I absolutely loved our time at the theatre. We went shopping at Lal Darwaza, and that was the day you talked to my Abba for the very first time.

Our fourth and final day was a light, fun day. We went to the mall, played bowling, had great food, and watched another movie. But when I dropped you off at your house, my heart sank knowing it was over :). I wished so badly we had just one more day. On the journey back, traveling on the same train, you wrapped your arms around my left shoulder and fell asleep. Knowing you felt safe with me made me so happy—those 3 hours were the absolute highlight of the entire trip. When you finally had to leave at Surat, it took me a while to digest that the trip was really over. I didn't tell you this, but I cried in the washroom after you left. But as I recalled all our great times, I told myself not to be sad that it ended, but to be thrilled because this was just the beginning of many more wonderful meetups. That thought is still one of the main things that drives me today. Once we were both home, I was so excited for our "Us time," and we started playing Uno, Spades, and Connect. That's how the greatest month of all time ended.

June was your vacation month! We explored new games like Escape Academy, Reanimal, and It Takes Two. We spent so much time on VC and doing sleep-alongs. And when your exam results came out and you scored even higher than you expected, it honestly felt like a personal success to me. I had seen your entire process and everything you went through, so watching you so happy that day made it all worth it. That ended our June on an amazing high.

In July, we kept the momentum going. Reels watchalongs, playing games, sleep-alongs, and VCs. Your college started back up, we built the Study bot together, and you began exploring all your options for after your MSc. We looked into colleges and syllabuses, and that's when our workalongs truly began.

That brings us to August. You went to Sapulara and shared those beautiful scenery images, and we spent the night playing games until morning. We explored job options for after your BSc or MSc. It's been a month of figuring things out. You might sometimes think you aren't making enough progress, but you have done so much more than most students your age. Many of them aren't even half as worried about their future yet, but you are already planning ahead. By the time you graduate, you'll have complete clarity while everyone else is just starting to panic. Trust me, you are making incredible progress.

Over this past year, you have become the best part of my daily routine. From our endless VC co-working sessions while you stress over CUET, forensic science notes, and crime scene diagrams, to the quiet moments where we just fall asleep on call, I cherish every single second I get to spend with you. You talked about wanting a Stand Up comedian-level funny friend, but to me, you are the funniest, smartest, and most beautiful girl in the room—even when you are threatening me with "Kottesta" over a dumb joke.

I love every single thing that makes you Yu. I love your Boori Buggalu and Pongu Buggalu, the way your face lights up when you're talking about a new Glossy lipstick shade, and how you demand to be called kachu pachu when you want affection. Even when you are overthinking your MSc syllabus, battling the IG algorithm, or sending me edgy reels just to test my patience, I wouldn't trade our dynamic for anything. Whenever I look at your Muthi pointing on screen, I realize exactly how lucky I am. If you ever ask me, "Entha Ishlam?" my answer is always going to be the exact same: Chaala ante Chaala Ishlam.

I know life gets chaotic, and we both get wound up and stressed with our own worlds, but you are my safe space, my Chitti Buggalu. I promise to always be here to help you decrypt those heavy forensic textbooks, to build you all the study tools you need to ace your career, and to be your anchor whenever things get overwhelming.

I have truly won in life because I have you, Ammulu. Have the happiest birthday today, and I cannot wait to celebrate so many more of these with you.

Love always,

Akash